
CRAZY SIMPLE **YOUTUBE**

Chapter Checklists

By Coach Aaron Cuha

24 Action-Step Checklists — One for Every Chapter

How to Use These Checklists

Each chapter of Crazy Simple YouTube ends with a "Crazy Simple Action" section — specific, concrete steps designed to move you from reading to doing. This document compiles all 24 action checklists in one printable resource.

Here is how to get the most from these checklists:

- 1. Print this document.** Physical checklists create accountability. Keep them next to your workspace.
- 2. Work chapter by chapter.** Complete each checklist before moving to the next. Speed is less important than execution.
- 3. Check the box when done.** Each checkbox is a small win. Small wins compound into transformational results.
- 4. Revisit quarterly.** Your channel will evolve. Return to these checklists every 90 days to recalibrate and level up.

Remember: A good video published beats a perfect video in progress.

Let's get to work.

CHAPTER 1

The \$387,000 YouTube Video

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Calculate Your YouTube Hourly Rate

- ☐ What is your average client or transaction value? \$_____
- ☐ If one YouTube video generates just ONE client per year, what is that video worth?
\$_____
- ☐ If that video keeps working for five years (conservative), what is the lifetime value?
\$_____
- ☐ If creating that video takes three hours, what is your "YouTube Hourly Rate"?
\$_____ per hour
- ☐ Write your YouTube Hourly Rate on a sticky note and put it somewhere visible

Notes:

CHAPTER 2

Why Most YouTube Advice Is Wrong**CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: The Myth Detox**

- ☐ Write down the three YouTube "rules" you've been following. Where did you learn each one?
- ☐ Pull up analytics: What is your average view duration on your last five videos? (If under 40%, your content strategy needs work)
- ☐ Pick the single most important question your ideal client would type into YouTube search. Write it down — that's your next video topic
- ☐ Delete one myth from your strategy (daily posting, short videos, obsessing over subscribers — pick one and cut it)

Notes:

CHAPTER 3

The 2026 YouTube Algorithm Decoded

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Your Algorithm Health Check

- ☐ Pull metrics for your five most recent videos: CTR%, AVD%, total video length, total watch time
- ☐ Calculate averages across all five videos
- ☐ Score against benchmarks: CTR above 5%? AVD above 45%? Video length over 8 minutes?
- ☐ Write down your single biggest bottleneck (CTR, AVD, or video length)
- ☐ Commit to fixing that specific problem in your next video

Notes:

CHAPTER 4

Your YouTube Business Model**CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Map Your Revenue Path**

- ☐ Choose your primary business model: Direct lead gen, authority building, digital products, affiliate, or ad revenue
- ☐ Define your lead magnet — the single most valuable free offer for YouTube viewers
- ☐ Decide where you'll send people (landing page tool and URL)
- ☐ Map your 3-step email follow-up sequence (write the three subject lines now)
- ☐ Calculate your conversion target (leads × close rate × client value = annual revenue)

Notes:

CHAPTER 5

The "Good Enough" Equipment Stack

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Your 10-Minute Equipment Audit

- ☐ Confirm: Do you own a smartphone, earbuds with mic, access to window light, and a phone prop? If yes, you have everything to start
- ☐ Be honest: Is equipment actually your bottleneck, or is it something else? Name the real obstacle
- ☐ Write down your Minimum Viable Setup (camera, audio, lighting — keep it simple)
- ☐ Pick a specific date to film your first video. Write it down and tell someone

Notes:

CHAPTER 6

Channel Setup That Converts

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Your One-Hour Channel Makeover

- ☐ 5 min: Channel name — does it pass the radio test? Change it if not
- ☐ 10 min: Upload a professional headshot as profile photo (800×800px)
- ☐ 15 min: Create banner in Canva with "Helping [AUDIENCE] achieve [OUTCOME] | [CREDIBILITY]" in safe zone
- ☐ 15 min: Rewrite About section (hook → credentials → content promise → links)
- ☐ 15 min: Create "Start Here" playlist + 3 topic-based playlists. Set best video as trailer

Notes:

CHAPTER 7

Finding Topics Your Audience Actually Searches For**CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: The 30-Minute Topic Bank Builder**

- ☐ 10 min: Alphabet soup — type your main topic in YouTube incognito, capture all autocomplete suggestions (a-z)
- ☐ 10 min: Competitor research — find 3 channels, sort by Most Popular, note winning topics
- ☐ 5 min: Client questions — write down 10 most common questions clients ask you
- ☐ 5 min: Pick your first four video topics. Run through validation filter (demand, rankable, right audience, expertise, evergreen)
- ☐ Put a specific filming date next to video #1

Notes:

CHAPTER 8

Titles and Thumbnails That Get Clicks

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: The Title and Thumbnail Audit

- ☐ Sort videos by CTR. Study your top 3 and bottom 3. Write down the pattern that separates winners from losers
- ☐ Rewrite titles for your 3 lowest-CTR videos using chapter formulas (specificity, curiosity, search intent)
- ☐ Redesign thumbnails on underperformers if needed (face, simple text, bright colors)
- ☐ Before your next video: write 3 title options and design thumbnail concept FIRST, then film
- ☐ Start a swipe file — screenshot every title/thumbnail that makes you click

Notes:

CHAPTER 9

The First 30 Seconds: Hooks That Keep Viewers Watching

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: The Hook Overhaul

- ☐ Watch the first 30 seconds of your last 3 videos. Are you committing any of the 5 opening sins? (Generic greeting, subscribe beg, long intro, slow wind-up, apology)
- ☐ Choose your default hook formula (Problem-Agitate-Promise, Shocking Statement, Story, Direct Question, Preview Stack, Proof, or Cold Open)
- ☐ Write a word-for-word hook for your next video using your chosen formula
- ☐ Write a one-sentence credibility statement to follow the hook
- ☐ Practice delivering your hook out loud 3 times before filming

Notes:

CHAPTER 10

Structuring Videos for Maximum Retention

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Build Your Retention Blueprint

- ☐ Pick your structure: Countdown, Problem-Solution, Story Arc, or Tutorial
- ☐ Map 5 value peaks: Hook, 25% major insight, 50% surprise/pivot, 75% most actionable content, closing
- ☐ Write 3 tease statements that bridge between peaks (at 25%, 50%, 75%)
- ☐ Plan pattern interrupts: 6+ for a 10-min video (camera changes, B-roll, graphics, tone shifts) spaced 60-90 sec apart
- ☐ Identify 2 danger zones and write prevention plans for each

Notes:

CHAPTER 11

Scripting and Delivery: Finding Your On-Camera Voice**CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION:** Find Your Scripting Sweet Spot

- ☐ Rate your camera comfort (1-10). Identify your biggest delivery challenge (freezing, robotic, rambling, low energy, too many takes)
- ☐ Build your reusable outline template: hook format, credibility statement, content structure, CTA, closing
- ☐ Design your pre-recording ritual: physical warm-up → vocal warm-up → mental reset → review hook → press record
- ☐ Film a practice video this week (not for publishing). Watch it back. Note one thing to improve. Film again

Notes:

CHAPTER 12

Editing for Engagement, Not Perfection

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Build Your Editing Template

- ☐ 10 min: Audit current process — how long does editing take? Where does time go?
- ☐ 15 min: Build template in editing software (intro style, lower-third, text style, music approach, outro)
- ☐ 5 min: Set maximum editing time per video (2 hours recommended). Allocate across 5 phases: rough cut, tightening, enhancement, audio, review
- ☐ Post near your editing setup: "A good video published beats a perfect video in progress"

Notes:

CHAPTER 13

Publishing and Optimization: The Launch Sequence**CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Build Your Launch Checklist**

- ☐ Create pre-publish checklist: title review, description template, tags, thumbnail upload, playlist assignment, end screen
- ☐ Create post-publish checklist: pinned comment, social shares, comment response schedule, 48-hour analytics review
- ☐ Build your description template now (opening hook, timestamps section, CTA paragraph, bio/subscribe section)
- ☐ Commit: no video gets published without completing both checklists

Notes:

CHAPTER 14

Building Your Content Calendar: Consistency That Lasts

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Build Your Sustainable System

- ☐ Reality check: How many hours per week during your busiest season? Choose frequency (1x/week for 2-3 hrs, 2x/week for 4-6 hrs)
- ☐ Design monthly batch schedule: planning day, filming day, editing rhythm. Block these as recurring calendar appointments
- ☐ Build safety net: 3 evergreen emergency topics, reduced-frequency plan, identify busiest season strategy
- ☐ Plan first 4 weeks: specific topic per week, label each (pillar/trending/connection), note batch filming groups

Notes:

CHAPTER 15

Analytics That Actually Matter: Reading Your Data

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Your First Analytics Audit

- ☐ Record channel averages (last 28 days): CTR, AVD (min + %), views/video, subscriber conversion per 1K views, monthly impressions
- ☐ Identify best and worst videos by AVD (not views). Compare: what's different?
- ☐ Retention graph deep-dive on 3 most recent videos: % remaining at 30 sec and 50% mark, biggest drop-off point
- ☐ Identify your single primary problem: CTR (packaging), Hook (first 30 sec), Structure (mid-video), or Impressions (consistency)
- ☐ Schedule weekly 15-minute analytics review as recurring calendar appointment

Notes:

CHAPTER 16

YouTube Shorts: The Strategic Approach for Business Channels

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Your Shorts Strategy

- ☐ Identify 3 moments from your best long-form video that could work as standalone Shorts
- ☐ Create one Short: extract clip, crop to 9:16, add captions, optimize opening 2 seconds, add CTA
- ☐ Set your Shorts ratio: 3-4 long-form videos for every 1-2 Shorts
- ☐ Commit: Shorts come from existing content only. No separate Shorts production workflow

Notes:

CHAPTER 17

Building Your Lead Generation System

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Build Your Lead System This Week

- ☐ 15 min: Design lead magnet — identify #1 audience problem, choose format (checklist/template/guide), write the title
- ☐ 30 min: Create capture page — headline, 3-5 benefit bullets, simple form (name + email)
- ☐ 15 min: Write standard promo elements — description link text, verbal CTA script, pinned comment template
- ☐ 30 min: Outline 5-email welcome sequence (deliver magnet → share insight → tell story → address objection → invite next step)
- ☐ Hard deadline: entire system goes live within 7 days

Notes:

CHAPTER 18

Converting YouTube Leads to Clients

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Optimize Your Sales Conversation

- ☐ 10 min: Audit current approach — estimate close rate, identify most common reason leads don't convert
- ☐ 15 min: Script consultation framework — YouTube acknowledgment question, 5 discovery questions, bridge statement, presentation outline, closing question
- ☐ 10 min: Prepare objection responses — "need to think about it," "can't I just watch more videos," "more than expected"
- ☐ 10 min: Build follow-up sequence — 24-hour email template, week-one check-in, long-term nurture plan

Notes:

CHAPTER 19

Building Your YouTube Team

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Prepare to Scale

- ☐ Readiness assessment: revenue generating? Proven system (3+ months)? Time bottleneck? Can articulate brand? Willing to manage?
- ☐ Track time for one week: log hours on each YouTube task (planning, filming, editing, thumbnails, descriptions, comments, promotion)
- ☐ Start documentation: 2-3 example videos as quality standard, list of things you DON'T want, step-by-step process from raw footage to published
- ☐ Design paid test project: what to ask, what to pay, what success looks like, red flags

Notes:

CHAPTER 20

The Mental Game: Psychology and Resilience for Creators

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Build Your Resilience System

- ☐ Start Evidence Journal now — record every win (comments, leads, skills improved, proud moments). Add 1+ entry per week
- ☐ Set analytics boundaries — delete YouTube Studio app from phone, pick one weekly review day/time
- ☐ Identify 2-3 people for your creator support network. Reach out to at least one this week
- ☐ Make the 100-video commitment: "I commit to publishing 100 videos before evaluating whether YouTube works"

Notes:

CHAPTER 21

Building Your YouTube Community: From Viewers to Advocates

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Launch Your Community Strategy

- ☐ Define community identity: What are members trying to achieve? Shared values? Community name? What makes someone "one of us"?
- ☐ Set engagement commitment: comment response window, morning + evening engagement slots, total daily minutes
- ☐ Create question bank: Write 5 specific end-of-video questions for your niche
- ☐ Plan 2 weeks of Community tab posts (3x/week: polls, behind-the-scenes, tips)
- ☐ Baseline metrics: current avg comments/video, repeat commenters by name, 30-day and 90-day goals

Notes:

CHAPTER 22

Repurposing Content: Maximum Reach, Minimum Effort

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Build Your Repurposing System

- ☐ Choose your 2 platforms beyond YouTube (where your audience already spends time)
- ☐ Define content types per platform (what you'll create, how often, scheduling tool)
- ☐ Map workflow: who extracts clips, transcription tool, batch day/time, who writes posts, who schedules
- ☐ Repurpose your last video RIGHT NOW: identify best clip moment, write LinkedIn post or email draft

Notes:

CHAPTER 23

Measuring Your YouTube ROI: Tracking What Actually Matters

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Build Your Tracking System Today

- ☐ Set up source tracking: create UTM-tagged link for lead magnet, add "How did you find me?" to intake form, write consultation opening question
- ☐ Create Client Source Log in Google Sheets (5 columns: Name, Source, Videos Mentioned, Date, Revenue)
- ☐ Baseline your numbers (last 90 days): total views, leads, consultations, clients, revenue from YouTube
- ☐ Calculate starting ROI: $(\text{Revenue} - \text{Investment}) \div \text{Investment} \times 100$
- ☐ Set quarterly review date on calendar

Notes:

CHAPTER 24

Your 90-Day Roadmap: From Here to 10,000 Subscribers

CRAZY SIMPLE ACTION: Your Commitment

- ☐ Write your WHY: "I'm building this YouTube channel because _____"
- ☐ Set your schedule: videos/week, publishing day, hours/week, content creation day/time
- ☐ This week's actions: write 3 specific actions with due dates
- ☐ Accountability: who you'll share this with, how often you'll review progress, what you'll do if you miss a week
- ☐ Sign it: "I commit to following this 90-day roadmap. Consistency beats perfection."

Notes:
